

# Xin Sun

Tokyo, JP / Amsterdam, NL

Email: [xin.von.sun@gmail.com](mailto:xin.von.sun@gmail.com)

Web: [xin-von-sun.github.io](https://xin-von-sun.github.io)

Researcher in Natural Language Processing, Human-Computer Interaction, and Cognitive Psychology.

## Highlights

- Cross-disciplinary researcher combining HCI, NLP, and cognitive psychology to study human language processing and LLM alignment with human needs, across academia and industry in the Netherlands, Japan, Germany, and China.
- Proficient in both qualitative and quantitative research methods, with expertise in multimodal human sensing including eye tracking, ECG, EDA, and behavioral measures.
- Publications at top-tier venues across NLP (ACL, EMNLP, COLING) and HCI (ACM CHI, CSCW, ICMI, IUI, IHCS, JMIR).

## Research and Working Experience

### National Institute of Informatics (NII)

Specially Appointed Assistant Professor

Jun 2025 – Present

Tokyo, Japan

- Study human language perception and align AI systems with intervention design for human augmentation.

### University of Amsterdam

Guest Postdoctoral Researcher

Mar 2025 – Jun 2026

Amsterdam, the Netherlands

- Investigate how users judge and trust LLM-generated versus human-authored information.

### Centrum Wiskunde & Informatica (CWI)

PhD Researcher

Aug 2023 – Apr 2025

Amsterdam, the Netherlands

- Built LLM-based health intervention systems and trustworthy interfaces using behavioral and physiological sensing.

### Alibaba Group, New Retail Technology Group

NLP Algorithm Engineer Intern

May 2020 – Oct 2020

Hangzhou, China

- Developed keyphrase extraction and summarization workflows with active learning and data augmentation.

### SAP, Intelligent Data & Analytics

Data Scientist Intern

Apr 2019 – Oct 2019

Walldorf, Germany

- Built stochastic forecasting workflows on SAP HANA with feature engineering and data visualization.

### Applied Technology Research Institute of Tsinghua University

Machine Learning Researcher Intern

Jul 2018 – Sep 2018

China

- Modeled ECG signals and constructed knowledge graphs for cardiac state analysis.

## Education

### University of Amsterdam

PhD in NLP / HCI / Physio-Psychology

Apr 2021 – Oct 2025

Amsterdam, the Netherlands

Thesis: From Aligned Models to Trusted Interfaces: Explainable Health Intervention and Transparent Health Information Seeking.

### Heidelberg University, Heidelberg, Germany

MSc in Scientific Computing (Optimization and NLP)

Nov 2017 – Jan 2021

Germany

### Xidian University (211 Program)

BSc in Computational Mathematics

Sep 2011 – Jul 2015

China

## Publications

### First-Author Conference Publications

17. **Xin Sun**, Di Wu, Sijing Qin, Isao Echizen, Abdallah El Ali, Saku Sugawara. The “Label Effect”: Source Bias and Alignment in Trust Assessment by Human and LLM-as-a-Judge. ACL 2026 Main Conference.
16. **Xin Sun**, Shu Wei, Jos A. Bosch, Isao Echizen, Abdallah El Ali, Saku Sugawara. Eyes Can’t Always Tell: Fusing Eye Tracking and User Priors for User Modeling under AI Advice Condition. ACM UMAP 2026 Oral.
15. **Xin Sun**, Shu Wei, Jos A. Bosch, Isao Echizen, Saku Sugawara, Abdallah El Ali. Seeing the Reasoning: How LLM Rationales Influence User Trust and Decision-Making in Fact-Checking Tasks. ACM CHI 2026 Poster.
14. **Xin Sun**, Jan de Wit, Zhuying Li, Jiahuan Pei, Abdallah El Ali, Jos A. Bosch. Script-Strategy Aligned Generation: Aligning LLMs with Domain Expertise and Therapeutic Strategies for Psychotherapy. ACM CSCW 2025 Oral.
13. **Xin Sun**, Xiao Tang, Abdallah El Ali, Zhuying Li, Pengjie Ren, Jan de Wit, Jiahuan Pei, Jos Bosch. Rethinking the Alignment of Psychotherapy Dialogue Generation with Motivational Interviewing Strategies. COLING 2025 Oral.
12. **Xin Sun**, Erkan Basar, Iris Hendrickx, Jan de Wit, Tibor Bosse, Gert-Jan de Bruijn, Jos Bosch, Emiel Krahmer. How Well Can LLMs Reflect? A Human Evaluation of LLM-Generated Reflections for MI Dialogues. COLING 2025 Oral.
11. **Xin Sun**, Lei Wang, Yue Li, Jie Li, Massimo Poesio, Julian Frommel, Koen Hindriks, Jiahuan Pei. Talking-to-Build: How LLM-Assisted Interface Shapes Player Performance and Experience in Minecraft. ACM ICMI 2025 Oral.
10. **Xin Sun**, Yunjie Liu, Jos A. Bosch, Zhuying Li. Interface Matters: Exploring Trust Perception in Health Information from Large Language Models via Text, Speech, and Embodiment. ACM CSCW 2024 Oral.

9. **Xin Sun**, Jiahuan Pei, Jan de Wit, Mohammad Aliannejadi, Emiel Krahmer, Jos TP Dobber, Jos Bosch. Eliciting Motivational Interviewing Skill Codes in Psychotherapy with LLMs: A Bilingual Dataset and Analytical Study. COLING 2024.
8. **Xin Sun**, Yunjie Liu, Jan de Wit, Jos A. Bosch, Zhuying Li. Trust by Interface: How Different User Interfaces Shape Human Trust in Health Information from LLMs. ACM CHI 2024 Poster.
7. **Xin Sun**, Isabelle Teljeur, Zhuying Li, Jos A. Bosch. Can a Funny Chatbot Make a Difference? Infusing Humor into Conversational Agent for Behavioral Intervention. ACM CUI 2024 Oral.
6. **Xin Sun**, Emiel Krahmer, Jan de Wit, Reinout Wiers, Jos A. Bosch. Plug and Play Conversations: The Micro-Conversation Scheme for Modular Development of Hybrid Conversational Agents. ACM CSCW 2023 Poster.
5. **Xin Sun**, Jos A. Bosch, Jan de Wit, Emiel Krahmer. Human-in-the-Loop Interaction for Continuously Improving Generative Models in Conversational Agents for Behavioral Intervention. ACM IUI 2023 Poster.
4. **Xin Sun**, Boris Schmitz, Jos A. Bosch. TIMELY: Providing In-Time Support for Cardiovascular Rehabilitation with Patients and Practitioners in the Loop. ACM IUI 2023 Poster.
3. **Xin Sun** et al. Virtual Support for Real-World Movement: Using Chatbots to Overcome Barriers to Physical Activity. Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence and Applications. HHA1 2023 Oral.
2. **Xin Sun** et al. Trustworthy AI for Mental Health Support: Survey and Position for Multi-Party Stakeholders. Under review.
1. **Xin Sun** et al. How LLM Reasoning Rationales Shape User Trust and Decisions: From Gaze Sensing to User-State Prediction. Under review.

### Journal and Book Publications

6. **Xin Sun**, Rongjun Ma, Shu Wei, Pablo César Garcia, Jos A. Bosch, Abdallah El Ali. Understanding Trust Perception in AI-Generated Information with Behavioral and Physiological Sensing (Eye-Tracking and Physiological Study). International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (IJHCS).
5. **Xin Sun**, Rongjun Ma, Xiaochang Zhao, Janne Lindqvist, Jan de Wit, Zhuying Li, Abdallah El Ali, Jos Bosch. From Agents to Interfaces: Understanding Trust in Health Information from Conversational Search. Behavioral & Information Technology.
4. Gert-Jan de Bruijn, Divyaa Balaji, **Xin Sun**. Chapter 16: Chatbots for Health Communication. In Health, Media, and Communication. De Gruyter Mouton, 2025.
3. Xiao Tang, Zhuying Li, **Xin Sun**, Xuhai “Orson” Xu, Min-Ling Zhang. ZzzMate: Designing an Empathetic Chatbot for Addressing Self-Conscious Emotions for Sleep Adherence. International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IJHCI).
2. Zhuying Li, Yan Wang, **Xin Sun**. Integrating Culture in Human-Food Interaction: A Study of Cultural and Creative Food Experiences and Technological Interactions. International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (IJHCS).
1. Mirela Habibovic, Emma Douma, Hendrik Schäfer, Manuela Sestayo-Fernandez, Tom Roovers, **Xin Sun**, ... Boris Schmitz. A Patient-Centered Risk Prediction, Prevention and Intervention Platform to Support the Continuum of Care in Coronary Artery Disease Using eHealth and Artificial Intelligence. Journal of Medical Internet Research (JMIR).

### Co-Author Publications

9. Qingyu Meng, Min Chen, Dingming Liu, Yifan Mo, Yue Su, **Xin Sun**, Koen Hindriks, Jiahuan Pei. StoryMI: Steerable Multi-Agent Therapeutic Dialogue Generation. ACL 2026.
8. Zhuying Li, Yishu Wang, Yan Wang, **Xin Sun**. Zenergy: Designing Taoist-Inspired Transformative Nature Imagery for Everyday Empowerment. ACM CHI 2026 Oral.
7. Zhuying Li, Ziteng Zhang, **Xin Sun**, Yan Wang. Digital Spirituality in Mainland China: Understanding Online Practices for Designing Culturally Relevant Spiritual Experiences. ACM CSCW 2026 Oral.
6. Yuto Mandai, Katie Seaborn, Tomoyasu Nakano, **Xin Sun**, Yijia Wang, Jun Kato. Super Kawaii Vocalics: Amplifying the “Cute” Factor in Computer Voice. ACM CHI 2025 Oral.
5. Xiao Tang, Zhuying Li, **Xin Sun**, Xuhai “Orson” Xu, Min-Ling Zhang. ZzzMate: Designing an Empathetic Chatbot for Addressing Self-Conscious Emotions for Sleep Adherence. ACM CHI 2025 Poster.
4. Xiao Wang, Jiahuan Pei, Diancheng Shui, Zhiguang Han, **Xin Sun**, Dawei Zhu, Xiaoyu Shen. MultiJustice: A Chinese Dataset for Multi-Party, Multi-Charge Legal Prediction. NLPCC 2025.
3. Jiahuan Pei, Fanghua Ye, **Xin Sun**, Wentao Deng, Koen Hindriks, Junxiao Wang. Conversational Education at Scale: A Multi-LLM Agent Workflow for Procedural Learning and Pedagogic Quality Assessment. EMNLP 2025.
2. Zhuying Li, Si Cheng, Zhenhuan Chen, **Xin Sun**, Jiatong Li, Ding Ding. SleepyFlora: Supporting Sleep Sharing and Augmentation over a Distance for Social Bonding across Time Zones. ACM CSCW 2023 Poster.
1. Benjamin Beilharz, **Xin Sun**, Sariya Karimova, Stefan Riezler. LibriVoxDeEn-A Corpus for German-to-English Speech Translation and Speech Recognition. LREC 2020.

### Leading Projects & Service

- **Funding:** Contributor or co-PI on JST (Japan), Wellcome Trust (UK), and EU Horizon 2020 projects; PI applicant for JSPS Grant for Young Scientists.
- **Reviewing:** ACM (CHI, CSCW, CHI PLAY, CUI), ACL ARR, COLING, Frontiers in Physiology, IJHCS, IJHCI, Behavioral & Information Technology, and TOIS.
- **Mentoring:** Supervised 10 Bachelor's, 7 master's, 3 PhD's interns and theses across domains of computer science (NLP and HCI), psychology, and brain and cognition at institutes in the Netherlands, Japan, and China.

## Core Skills

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**LLM & NLP:** LLM alignment, dialogue systems, evaluation, prompting, dataset design, PyTorch

**Human-AI Research:** HCI, user studies, surveys, qualitative interviews, trustworthy AI

**Human Sensing & Analytics:** Eye tracking, ECG, EDA, behavioral analysis, qualitative and quantitative methods

**Programming:** Python, JavaScript, SQL, web APIs, agents, data visualization

**Speaking Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (C1), German (B1)